Bauhaus-Universität Weimar
Faculty of Media
Degree Programme Computer Science for Digital Media

Generative Agents School: The Impact of Thuringian Government Programs on Generative Students

Social Simulacra

Julian Klüber — Matriculation Number 129164
Varuna Sethuraman — Matriculation Number 129311

Submission date: August 30, 2026

Abstract

Educational policies are fundamentally political, yet real-world coalition building blurs how uncompromised party ideologies independently shape student development and classroom dynamics. To isolate these political effects, we construct a multi-agent simulation that translates the 2024 Thuringian election programs of five political parties (Die Linke, SPD, Bündnis 90/Die Grünen, CDU, and AfD) into distinct virtual school environments governing rules, grading, and pedagogical structures. Using a single initial state of autonomous LLM-driven student and teacher agents at a simulated gymnasium, we fork the simulation into five parallel timelines for one school day. Shifts in student psychological profiles are measured by administering the Big Five Inventory-2 (BFI-2) before and after the simulation. Results reveal a uniform structural exposure effect where all party regimes significantly increase student Open-Mindedness ($\Delta = 0.65$–$0.83, p < 0.05$). However, party-specific frameworks produce marked variance in magnitude: Die Linke drives the strongest pro-social outcomes with the largest gains in Agreeableness ($\Delta = 0.56$) and reductions in Negative Emotionality ($\Delta = -0.31$); SPD maximizes Open-Mindedness; CDU exhibits the fewest significant shifts, maintaining profile stability; and AfD unexpectedly yields the highest Extraversion gains ($\Delta = 0.44$). This work demonstrates the viability of generative multi-agent social simulations for assessing the downstream psychological impacts of educational policy frameworks.

Contents

1 Introduction

Education represents one of the primary pillars of human society, serving as a vital mechanism for cultural transmission, social reproduction, and civic preparation [Dew16; BP70]. Since antiquity, older generations have transmitted knowledge, skills, and cultural norms to younger generations, enabling societies to build upon accumulated experience and advance institutionally. Modern states formalize this process through public schooling, establishing standardized environments wherein children acquire the necessary competencies to participate in democratic life [Dew16].

However, formal education is inherently value-laden; decisions regarding what knowledge is essential and how classrooms should be governed are fundamental political questions [App04]. In democratic systems such as Germany, state governments determine educational policies, curriculum frameworks, and school structures. Political parties hold sharply contrasting visions of educational priorities. In practice, democratic coalition building forces political parties to compromise, meaning that pure ideological platforms are rarely observed in isolation within real-world classrooms. Evaluating how these uncompromised party programs independently affect student well-being, social dynamics, and personality development presents a methodological challenge.

To overcome real-world policy blurring and isolate party-specific educational visions, this project constructs a simulated educational environment using the generative agents architecture introduced by Park et al. [Par+23]. By instantiating autonomous LLM-driven agents within a controlled sandbox environment, we translate the distinct educational programs of *Die Linke*, *SPD*, *Die Grünen*, *CDU*, and *AfD* into explicit school rules and classroom curricula. Holding the baseline environment constant, we fork a single initial state into five parallel timelines, simulating a school day under each party's distinct regime. To evaluate the impact of each party framework, we administer the Big Five Inventory-2 (BFI-2) to student agents before the simulation fork and after the completion of the simulated school day to assess shifts in their personality traits.

2 Related Work

The idea of simulating human behaviour using AI agents has gained a lot of attention in the last few years. Park et al. [Par+22] introduced Social Simulacra, an early attempt that utilized LLMs to populate social computing systems with artificial social behaviours. Building on this, Park et al. [Par+23] developed the Smallville project, where 25 AI agents live in a small town, planning and executing their actions, having memory of past events and interacting with each other without being manually controlled. In particular, EduAgent [XZQ24] applies a similar concept to the educational domain, creating student agents to simulate how real students learn and behave in a classroom. The authors demonstrated that student agents could simulate different learning styles and respond differently to teaching strategies, showing the potential of LLM agents to reflect individual student characteristics in educational settings. Similarly, Zhang et al. [Zha+25] created a classroom environment where both teacher and student agents interact with each other. Their results revealed that agents could effectively participate in classroom communications and dialogues, such as asking or answering questions, but the quality depended heavily on how the agents were prompted. However, none of these works analysed how political ideology may shape agent personality in a school environment, which is the main focus of our Generative Agents School.

The relationship between politics and education is not new. Dewey [Dew16] argued that schools do not just teach knowledge but also transmit values and shape how students see society. The same relationship is reflected in the theories developed by Bourdieu and Passeron [BP70], who showed that schools tend to reproduce existing social inequalities in favour of students whose cultural background aligns with what the school considers valuable. Furthermore, Apple [App04] also showed that curricula of education are not neutral but always reflect the ideology of those in power. These theories connect directly to our project, in which we translate the educational programs of five Thuringian parties (*Die Linke*, *SPD*, *Bündnis 90/Die Grünen*, *CDU*, and *AfD*)into distinct school environments and observe how student agents behave in each environment. By doing this, we can explore how various educational policies would affect student personalities without being limited by real-world conditions.

One of the challenges in agent simulation is measuring how exactly an agent changes throughout the simulation or across different environments. One way to address this is to conduct structured interviews with agents, similar to how researchers analyse people in social studies. Li et al. [Li+26] introduce the InterviewSim framework, which uses structured interviews in order to simulate and evaluate personality traits of agents. The authors concluded that structured interviews are an effective way to evaluate agent personality consistency, and that agents maintained relatively stable personality traits across different interview sessions. This is closely related to our approach, where we interview student agents before and after they experience a party-specific school environment. Park et al. [Par+23] further showed the importance of grounding agents in personal context and self-reports in order to simulate individuals more accurately across various outcomes. He found that agents grounded in detailed personal background information, including survey items and self-reports, could simulate real human responses with surprising accuracy. Therefore, we evaluate the impact of the political school environment primarily through pre- and post-simulation interviews that draw on the agents' memory retrieval and rich personal context. For the interviews we use the Big Five Inventory-2 (BFI-2) [SJ17], a widely used psychological assessment tool that measures five major dimensions of personality: Openness, Conscientiousness, Extraversion, Agreeableness, and Negative Emotionality. By comparing the pre- and post-simulation interviews across the five party environments, we want to identify how the political school environment influences the agents' personality.

3 Methodology

This project builds on the generative agents framework introduced by Park et al. [Par+23], which provides the foundation for building agents with persistent memory, daily planning, and natural language conversation. We extend this framework with a school setting called Goethe Gymnasium, where one teacher agent and four student agents interact with each other during a school day. To test the impact of political ideology on agent personality, we create five parallel school environments, each based on the 2024 Thuringian election program of one of the following political parties: *Die Linke*, *SPD*, *Bündnis 90/Die Grünen*, *CDU*, and *AfD*.

3.1 Agent Design

Each agent is defined by a configuration file (see Figure 3.1) that describes their name, age, innate, current state in life (learned), current actions/behaviour (currently), speech pattern and lifestyle. This configuration file is the initial state of the agent before the simulation gets forked into five parallel timelines. The student agents are designed to represent a diverse set of character traits and school motivation with Sofia Petrova being extroverted, Lukas Schneider being introverted, Mohammed Idrissi being unmotivated and Aylin Demir being motivated, while the teacher agent Katharina Weber is designed to be strict and fair. Each agent has a memory system that allows them to store and retrieve

```
"name": "Mohammed Idrissi",
"first_name": "Mohammed",
"last_name": "Idrissi",
"age": 16,
"innate": "easily bored, laid-back, a bit insecure about school",
"learned": "Mohammed is in 10th grade at Bauhaus Gymnasium. His grades are bad and he knows
"currently": "Mohammed is barely keeping up in most subjects and has a make-up test coming u
"speech_pattern": "Short, low-effort sentences. Deflects with jokes. Uses slang ('nah', 'bru
"lifestyle": "Mohammed stays up late gaming until 01:00am most nights, dragging himself out
```

Figure 3.1: Personal components of the agent configuration file. One example for the student agent *Mohammed Idrissi*

information about past events, interactions, and experiences, which influences their behavior and decision-making throughout the simulation.

3.2 Party Environment Implementation

The party-specific environments were implemented based on a systematic comparison of the five Thuringian party programs across five categories: school system and structure, grading and assessment, instruction and pedagogical concepts, digitalization and media, and inclusion and language support (see Appendix A.1). Each agent receives a history file describing background knowledge about their school that reflects the educational program of the assigned party. For example, agents in the *Die Linke* environment know that grades are replaced by individual feedback, and homework is reduced, while agents in the *CDU* environment know that conduct grades (*Kopfnoten*) are evaluated, the BLF [1] exam must be passed, and traditional German spelling rules are strictly enforced. The teacher agent's daily schedule and classroom behaviour were also modified to reflect each party's vision of how a teacher should operate.

3.3 Simulation and Interviews

Each simulation runs for one simulated school day until 12pm. Before the simulation begins, all agents are interviewed based on the BFI-2. After the school day is completed, the same agents are interviewed again based on the BFI-2. The interview responses are generated based on each agent's personal memory and current state at the time of the interview. By comparing the pre and post interview responses across the five party environments, we aim to identify how the political school environment influences the agents' expressed behaviour and attitudes.

[1] BLF (Besondere Leistungsfeststellung) refers to mandatory 10th-grade Gymnasium exams required to advance to grade 11 toward the Abitur. Passing them also grants an equivalent intermediate school certificate (Realschulabschluss).

4 Analysis

In this chapter, we present the results of the simulation experiments, focusing on the shifts in student agents' Big Five personality traits across the five party-specific educational environments. We analyze both group-level effects and individual-level variations to provide a comprehensive understanding of how different political party frameworks influence student development within the simulated school setting.

4.1 Group-Level Effects

For each of the five party environments, we compare the pre- and post-simulation BFI-2 interview responses for the four student agents using a paired Wilcoxon signed-rank test. Table A.2 shows the mean shift (Δ) in each domain, the standard deviation of that shift (sd_Δ), the paired Cohen's d effect size, and the p-value from the Wilcoxon test (p_t). The table also indicates which shifts are statistically significant at the $p < 0.05$ level.

Two patterns stand out. First, Open-Mindedness rises significantly in every single party environment (Δ between 0.65 and 0.83, all $p_t < 0.05$), making it the only domain with a uniformly significant effect across the full political spectrum represented in the simulation. Second, every environment moves every domain in the same direction: all five parties increase Extraversion, Agreeableness, Conscientiousness, and Open-Mindedness relative to base, and all five decrease Neg. Emotionality. No party reverses the sign of any domain. This uniformity suggests that part of the measured effect may be attributable to a general simulation exposure effect, meaning agents becoming more socially confident and less anxious simply from having lived through a structured school day and interacted with peers, independent of which party's policies governed that day rather than a purely party-specific ideological effect. We return to this as a limitation in Chapter 5.

Where the parties differ is in magnitude and in which domains cross the significance threshold (Appendix A.2):

- **Linke** produces the largest Agreeableness increase of any party ($\Delta = 0.56$, $d = 3.56$) and the largest decrease in Neg. Emotionality ($\Delta = -0.31$, $d = -2.98$), both significant. This is consistent with Die Linke's programme of non-selective schooling, individualised feedback instead of grades, and reduced homework (Section 3.2), which removes several common sources of peer competition and performance pressure.

- **Grüne** is the only other party with a significant Neg. Emotionality decrease ($\Delta = -0.25$, $d = -3.66$) alongside a significant Agreeableness gain, matching its stated emphasis on inclusion and modern, participatory pedagogy.

- **SPD** shows the strongest Open-Mindedness effect of all five parties ($\Delta = 0.83$) and is one of only two environments with a significant Extraversion increase ($\Delta = 0.21$, $p_t = 0.030$), broadly consistent with its focus on educational mobility and opportunity.

- **AfD** produces significant increases in Extraversion ($\Delta = 0.44$, the largest of any party), Agreeableness, and Open-Mindedness. This is a counter-intuitive result given the party's traditional, discipline-oriented programme, and is discussed further in Chapter 5.

- **CDU** is the environment with the fewest significant shifts, only Open-Mindedness reaches significance. Point estimates for Conscientiousness (0.35) and Extraversion (0.38) are comparable in size to the other parties, but higher within-agent variance (larger sd_Δ) keeps them below the significance threshold. This relative "flatness" is at least directionally consistent with a programme built around stability, performance standards, and the traditional multi-track structure.

Conscientiousness is the one domain that never reaches significance in any environment, despite positive point estimates throughout (0.31–0.40). Given paired Cohen's d values in the 0.6–1.0 range, this looks like a power problem rather than a null effect: the true shift is plausibly non-zero, but $n = 4$ students is not enough to detect a medium effect size reliably.

4.2 Individual-Level Variation

Group means can mask substantial disagreement between agents. Figure 4.1 breaks the domain shifts down by agent (including the teacher, Katharina Weber) and environment.

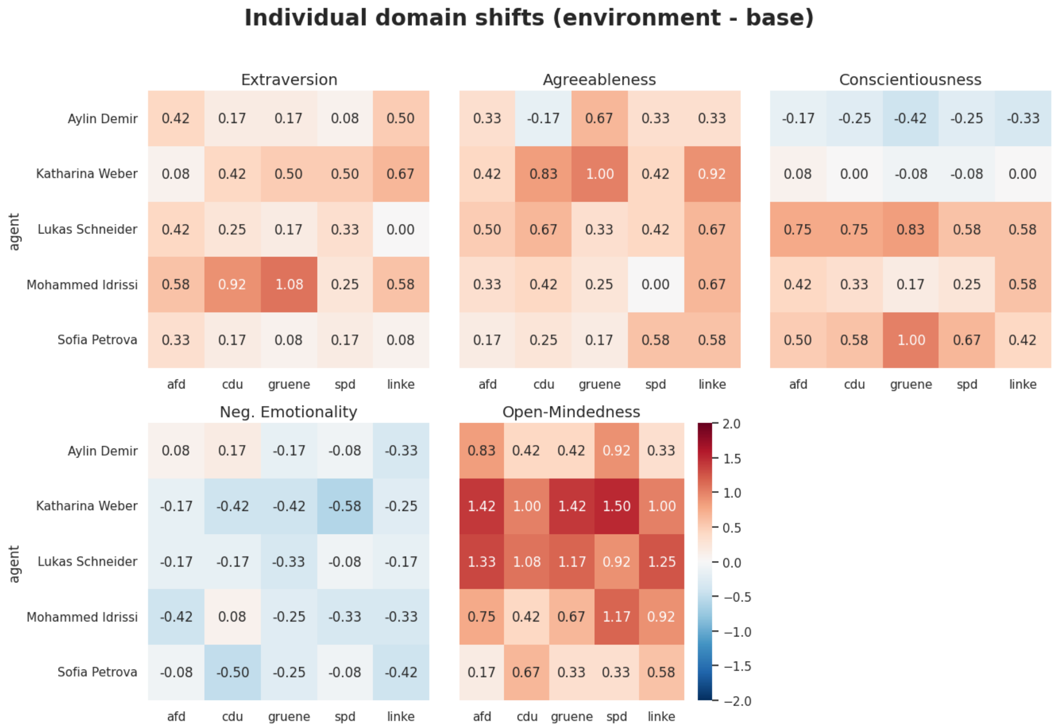

Figure 4.1: Individual domain shifts (environment − base) by agent. Katharina Weber is the teacher agent; the remaining four rows are the students used in Table A.2.

Within-Party Divergence

When examining variance across party environments, the **Grüne** condition generated the highest degree of within-group divergence among agents. Under Grüne, Conscientiousness exhibited a 1.42-point spread, ranging from a decline of −0.42 for Aylin Demir to a peak increase of +1.00 for Sofia Petrova. Similarly, Extraversion in the Grüne environment ranged widely from a negligible +0.08 for Sofia Petrova to a dramatic +1.08 spike for Mohammed Idrissi. The **CDU** environment likewise induced polarized behavioral adaptations, particularly within Agreeableness (−0.17 for Aylin versus +0.83 for Katharina) and Conscientiousness (−0.25 for Aylin versus +0.75 for Lukas). In contrast, the **Linke** and **SPD** environments yielded the lowest within-party divergence, fostering relatively uniform positive shifts in Open-Mindedness and Agreeableness across all student and teacher personas.

Environment-Driven Persona Transformations

At the individual interaction level, specific party environments acted as distinct catalysts for persona transformation, interacting directly with each agent's baseline design:

- **Katharina Weber (Teacher):** Experienced the highest overall transformation across all agents (mean absolute shift of 0.57). As the sole teacher figure, her baseline profile adapted most dynamically to the group dynamics, propelled by massive surges in Open-Mindedness that peaked under the **SPD** environment (+1.50, average +1.27) and heightened Agreeableness maximized within **Grüne** (+1.00, average +0.72).
- **Lukas Schneider (Introvert, quiet):** Despite his quiet and introverted baseline, Lukas closely mirrored the teacher's overall level of change as the second most transformed agent (mean absolute shift of 0.56). His reserved disposition gave way to pronounced cognitive flexibility, exhibiting maximum Open-Mindedness shifts in the ideologically polar environments of **AfD** (+1.33) and **Linke** (+1.25), alongside a strong surge in Conscientiousness under **Grüne** (+0.83, average +0.70).
- **Mohammed Idrissi (Unmotivated, bothered):** Characterized at baseline as unmotivated and bothered, Mohammed demonstrated a moderate overall shift (mean absolute shift of 0.49). His transformation was driven by selective social activation, where the **Grüne** (+1.08) and **CDU** (+0.92) environments induced his sharpest Extraversion boosts, directly counteracting his passive baseline persona.
- **Sofia Petrova (Extrovert, talkative):** Designed as an outgoing and expressive baseline persona, Sofia proved comparatively resilient to structural changes overall (mean absolute shift of 0.37). Instead of altering her high sociability, party environments redirected her energy into task orientation, achieving her peak Conscientiousness increase under **Grüne** (+1.00) and her greatest reduction in Negative Emotionality within **CDU** (−0.50).
- **Aylin Demir (Motivated, structured):** Defined at baseline as highly organized and goal-driven, Aylin was the most stable agent overall (mean absolute shift of 0.33). Paradoxically, the simulated party environments eroded her core baseline strengths, yielding a consistent drop in Conscientiousness across every single condition (average −0.28, sharpest decline of −0.42 under **Grüne**) even as **Grüne** brought out her highest Agreeableness (+0.67).

4.3 Facet-Level Detail

Figure 4.2 disaggregates the five domains into their 15 constituent BFI-2 facets, plotting the group-mean facet profile for each environment against the base measurement.

The facet view shows that the domain-level Open-Mindedness effect is carried primarily by *Intellectual Curiosity* and *Aesthetic Sensitivity*, which separate most clearly from the base profile across all five environments, while *Creative Imagination* shows a smaller gap. Within Agreeableness, *Respectfulness* shows the largest and most consistent separation from base of the three facets, plausibly reflecting that a full day inside any of the five structured party environments, each with its own explicit classroom rules, increases agents' expressed respect for those rules and for the teacher, while *Trust* moves by comparatively less. Within Conscientiousness, *Organization* separates from base more than *Productiveness* or *Responsibility*, consistent with the domain-level result being real but individually noisy (Section 4.2). The Negative Emotionality facets move together as a block, with *Depression* showing the clearest environment-vs-base gap and *Anxiety* the smallest, matching the domain-level finding that the overall Neg. Emotionality decrease is modest but directionally consistent.

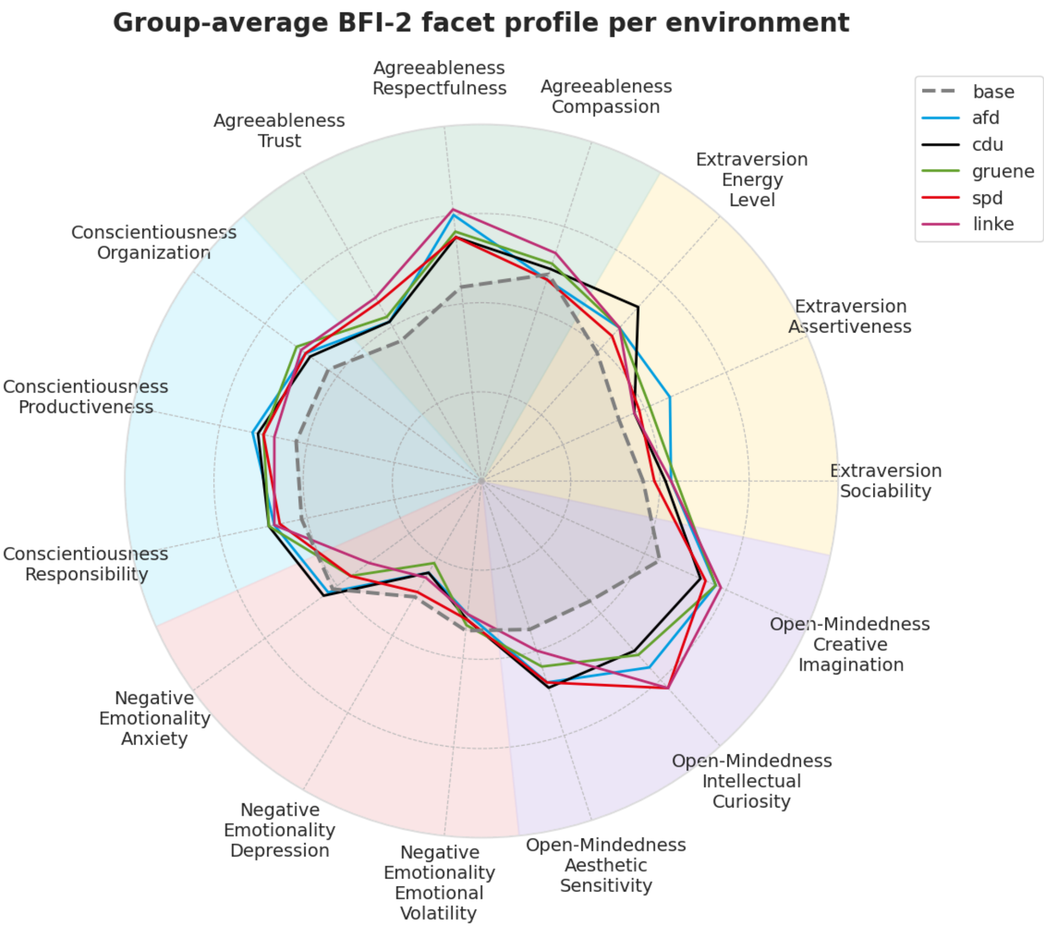

Figure 4.2: Group-average BFI-2 facet profile per environment (15 facets, base vs. five party environments).

5 Summary and Limitations

Across all five simulated party environments, student agents' expressed Big Five profiles shifted in the same direction with higher Extraversion, higher Agreeableness, higher Conscientiousness, higher Open-Mindedness and lower Negative Emotionality relative to the pre-simulation baseline. Reliable statistical significance is concentrated in Open-Mindedness (all five parties), Agreeableness (AfD, Grüne, Linke), Extraversion (AfD, SPD), and Neg. Emotionality (Grüne, Linke).

Linke produced the strongest pro-social effect (largest Agreeableness gain, largest Neg. Emotionality drop), consistent with its low-pressure, non-selective programme, while CDU produced the fewest significant shifts overall, consistent with its stability- and discipline-oriented programme. SPD's environment stood out for the largest Open-Mindedness gain, and AfD unexpectedly combined the largest Extraversion gain with significant Agreeableness and Open-Mindedness gains despite its traditional, discipline-focused platform.

This last result, together with the fact that no domain reverses sign in any environment, is a reason for caution rather than a straightforward finding about AfD's programme specifically.

Three limitations must be taken into account for interpretation:

1. **Sample size.** The paired analysis rests on $n = 4$ students per environment. This may be enough to detect very large effects (Open-Mindedness, $d > 1.6$ throughout) but underpowered for the medium effects seen in Conscientiousness, and it limits the Wilcoxon test to a small set of possible p-values, several of which never reach $p < 0.05$ regardless of effect size.

2. **Uniform direction across parties.** Every environment shifted every domain the same way, which is consistent with a general "day in a structured simulated school with peers" effect that is at least partly independent of the specific party programme. The between-party differences we report are therefore best read as differences in magnitude on top of

a shared baseline exposure effect, not as fully independent, party-caused effects.

3. **Time and Cost limits.** To run the simulation for a school day until 12pm, each environment took approximately 4 hours, because every time the agents reflect or converse, they must generate multiple LLM responses. Those LLM calls are expensive, and the simulation is time-consuming. This limits the number of agents and the number of days we can simulate, which in turn limits statistical power and the ability to observe longer-term effects.

Future work could extend the simulation to multiple school days per environment to test whether party-specific differences grow relative to the shared baseline effect and increase the number of student agents per timeline to improve statistical power if the simulation time and cost can be reduced.

Bibliography

[App04] Michael W. Apple. "Ideology and Curriculum". In: 3rd. Routledge, 2004. Chap. 1, 2, and 4, pp. 1–42, 61–81.

[BP70] Pierre Bourdieu and Jean-Claude Passeron. "Reproduction in Education, Society and Culture". In: Sage Publications, 1970. Chap. 1 and 2, pp. 5–53.

[Dew16] John Dewey. "Democracy and Education: An Introduction to the Philosophy of Education". In: Macmillan, 1916. Chap. 1, 2, and 7, pp. 1–27, 94–116.

[Li+26] Yu Li et al. "InterviewSim: A Scalable Framework for Interview-Grounded Personality Simulation". In: *CoRR* abs/2602.20294 (2026). DOI: 10.48550/ARXIV.2602.20294.

[Par+22] Joon Sung Park et al. "Social Simulacra: Creating Populated Prototypes for Social Computing Systems". In: *Proceedings of the 35th Annual ACM Symposium on User Interface Software and Technology.* 2022. DOI: 10.1145/3526113.3545616.

[Par+23] Joon Sung Park et al. "Generative Agents: Interactive Simulacra of Human Behavior". In: *CoRR* abs/2304.03442 (2023). DOI: 10.48550/ARXIV.2304.03442.

[SJ17] Christopher J. Soto and Oliver P. John. "The next Big Five Inventory (BFI-2): Developing and Assessing a Hierarchical Model With 15 Facets to Enhance Bandwidth, Fidelity, and Predictive Power". In: *Journal of Personality and Social Psychology* 113.1 (2017), pp. 117–143. DOI: 10.1037/pspp0000096.

[XZQ24] Songlin Xu, Xinyu Zhang, and Lianhui Qin. *EduAgent: Generative Student Agents in Learning.* 2024. DOI: 10.48550/arXiv.2404.07963.

[Zha+25] Zheyuan Zhang et al. “Simulating Classroom Education with LLM-Empowered Agents”. In: *Proceedings of the 2025 Conference of the Nations of the Americas Chapter of the Association for Computational Linguistics: Human Language Technologies (Volume 1: Long Papers)*. 2025, pp. 10364–10379. DOI: `10.18653/v1/2025.naacl-long.520`.

A Appendix

A.1 Party Policy Comparison

Table A.1: Comparison of Thuringian Party Positions on Educational Policy

Party	Key Program Points
	1. School System & Structure
Die Linke	• **School Type:** Expansion of the *Gemeinschaftsschule*[1]. • **All-day & After-school:** Expansion of all-day offers; abolition of after-school care (*Hort*[2]) fees (gradual expansion to grades 5–6); full-time contracts for educators. • **Administration & Participation:** State-wide hiring of school administration assistants; expansion of democratic student representation.
SPD	• **School Type:** Priority on *Gemeinschaftsschule*. • **All-day:** Genuine all-day concept (alternating instruction, leisure, and recovery throughout the day). • **Administration & Participation:** Hiring of administration assistants; student participation (50% of school conference based on Berlin model).
Bündnis 90/Die Grünen	• **School Type:** *Gemeinschaftsschule*. • **All-day & Relief:** Expansion of all-day schools; fee-free school transport and free learning materials. • **Support:** Guaranteed school social work at every school and strengthening school psychology.
CDU	• **School Type:** Retention of tracked school system; state-wide retention of special schools (*Förderschulen*[3]). • **All-day:** Retention of all-day offers alongside complete abolition of after-school care (*Hort*) fees.

Continued on next page

[1]**Gemeinschaftsschule:** Comprehensive school model in Germany where children of all ability levels learn together (grades 1–10/13).

[2]**Hort:** After-school care program located at primary schools.

[3]**Förderschule:** Specialized school for children with physical, mental, or learning disabilities.

Table A.1 – *Continued from previous page*

Party	Key Program Points
AfD	• **School Type:** Commitment to tracked system; upgrading *Regelschule*[4] and aligning *Gymnasium*[5] to university entry. • **All-day:** Rejection of mandatory all-day schools; voluntary afternoon care. • **Administration:** State-wide administrative assistants to relieve teachers.
	2. Grading & Assessment
Die Linke	• **Grading:** Advance assessment without numerical grades; abolition of grades in PE, music, and art. • **Graduation & Qualifications:** Abolition of Special Performance Assessment (*BLF*[6]) at *Gymnasien*; automatic acquisition of intermediate certificate (*Realschulabschluss*[7]) upon promotion to grade 11.
SPD	*(No specific details provided in the text)*
Bündnis 90/Die Grünen	• **Grading & Pressure:** Individual support over performance pressure; written evaluations instead of numerical grades in PE, art, and music. • **Graduation & Retention:** Abolishing *BLF* (automatic certificate on grade 11 promotion); abolishing grade retention in favor of targeted support.
CDU	• **Grading & Retention:** Reintroduction of conduct grades (*Kopfnoten*[8]: behavior, effort, participation, orderliness); binding promotion decisions starting grade 2. • **Graduation & Qualifications:** Retaining *BLF* in grade 10 as preparation for *Abitur*[9].
AfD	• **Grading & Retention:** Retaining/reintroducing classic grades starting grade 2 and conduct grades (*Kopfnoten*); enabling grade repetition in every grade level. • **Graduation & Qualifications:** Retaining *BLF* in grade 10, qualifying it as full intermediate certificate (*Realschulabschluss*).
	3. Instruction & Pedagogical Concepts
Die Linke	• **Pedagogical Assistance:** Permanent hiring and staff expansion of pedagogical assistants. • **School Life & Practice:** Developing individual school concepts involving parents/students; expanding polytechnic/practical learning.
SPD	• **Daily Schedule:** School start no earlier than 09:00 AM; shortening instructional units to 45–60 mins. • **Civic Education:** Expansion of social studies instruction; cross-curricular democratic orientation.

Continued on next page

[4] **Regelschule:** Secondary track in Thuringia combining vocational/general education.
[5] **Gymnasium:** Highest academic secondary track leading to university qualification.
[6] **BLF:** Besondere Leistungsfeststellung exam at end of 10th grade in Gymnasium.
[7] **Realschulabschluss:** Intermediate school leaving certificate after 10th grade.
[8] **Kopfnoten:** Conduct grades assessing behavior, effort, participation, orderliness.
[9] **Abitur:** Final qualification exam granting university entry.

Table A.1 – *Continued from previous page*

Party	Key Program Points
Bündnis 90/Die Grünen	• **Content & Curricula:** Cross-curricular teaching and modern curricula (mental health, nutrition); reviewing materials for discrimination. • **Learning Forms:** Reducing homework; strengthening learning outside school; joint dialogue module for ethics/religion.
CDU	• **Language & Values:** Standard spelling rules (ban on gender-neutral special characters); strengthening democracy/values education and culture of remembrance. • **Practice & STEM:** Strengthening STEM (*MINT*[10]) subjects; introducing state-wide "Day in Practice".
AfD	• **Orientation & Values:** Knowledge-based uniform curricula; teaching secondary virtues (punctuality, orderliness). • **Instructional Rules:** Strict ban on gender-neutral language; enforcement of neutrality mandate (*Beutelsbacher Konsens*[11]); rejection of Islamic religious education.
	4. Digitalization & Media
Die Linke	• **Access & Support:** Genuine free access to learning materials (analog & digital). • **Media Literacy:** Media concepts at every school; critical social media instruction from entry level; expanding technical support.
SPD	• **Access & Competence:** Free learning materials including digital end-user devices. • **Educational Goal:** Fostering "digital resilience" and critical media use.
Bündnis 90/Die Grünen	• **Infrastructure:** Guaranteeing digital device for every child; increasing infrastructure investments. • **Usage:** Expanding CS and media education; no blanket smartphone ban (determined with students).
CDU	• **Equipment:** Equipping students from grade 5 with loan devices via special funding. • **Support & Teaching:** Deploying "digital caretakers" for IT; mandatory AI/digital training in teacher education.
AfD	• **Stance:** "Digitalization with a sense of proportion"; rejecting replacement of teachers by digital media. • **AI & Media:** Pragmatic approach to AI (ChatGPT) in teaching instead of bans; educating about risks.
	5. Inclusion & Language Support
Die Linke	• **Inclusion:** Expanding right to inclusive education via modern settings and professional development. • **Language Support:** Overall concept for non-native German speakers focusing on German as Second Language (*DaZ*[12]) teachers.
SPD	• **Support:** Multi-professional teams on-site (special education teachers, *DaZ* teachers, social workers).

Continued on next page

[10]**MINT:** German equivalent of STEM (Math, CS, Sciences, Tech).
[11]**Beutelsbacher Konsens:** Guidelines mandating political neutrality in education.
[12]**DaZ:** German as a Second Language instruction programs.

Table A.1 – *Continued from previous page*

Party	Key Program Points
Bündnis 90/Die Grünen	• **Inclusion:** Improving joint learning of children with and without disabilities; trust teachers as anti-discrimination officers (*SAVE*[13]). • **Language Support:** Expanding capacities for *DaZ*.
CDU	• **Inclusion & Special Schools:** Parental school choice rights remain; state-wide retention of special schools (*Förderschulen*). • **Language Support:** Mandatory language tests prior to enrollment; creation of support classes.
AfD	• **Inclusion & Special Schools:** Priority on retaining and expanding special schools (*Förderschulen*). • **Language Support:** Mandatory preparatory classes with testing for foreign children lacking German skills.

[13]**SAVE-Beauftragte:** School officers designated for Anti-discrimination, Diversity, and Empowerment.

A.2 Big Five Personality Shift Analysis

Table A.2: Paired shift statistics per environment × domain ($n = 4$ students). Δ = mean shift (environment − base), d = paired Cohen's d, p_t = paired t-test p-value, p_W = Wilcoxon p-value. Bold rows are significant at $p_t < 0.05$.

Domain	Party	Δ	d	t	p_t	p_W
Extraversion	**AfD**	**0.438**	**4.18**	**8.35**	**0.004**	0.125
	CDU	0.375	1.03	2.07	0.131	0.125
	Grüne	0.375	0.79	1.58	0.212	0.125
	SPD	**0.209**	**1.95**	**3.89**	**0.030**	0.125
	Linke	0.292	1.00	1.99	0.140	0.250
Agreeableness	**AfD**	**0.333**	**2.45**	**4.90**	**0.016**	0.125
	CDU	0.292	0.83	1.66	0.195	0.250
	Grüne	**0.354**	**1.62**	**3.24**	**0.048**	0.125
	SPD	0.333	1.36	2.72	0.073	0.250
	Linke	**0.562**	**3.56**	**7.13**	**0.006**	0.125
Conscientiousness	AfD	0.375	0.97	1.93	0.149	0.250
	CDU	0.354	0.81	1.62	0.204	0.250
	Grüne	0.396	0.61	1.22	0.311	0.375
	SPD	0.312	0.75	1.50	0.230	0.375
	Linke	0.312	0.71	1.43	0.249	0.250
Neg. Emotionality	AfD	−0.146	−0.70	−1.40	0.257	0.375
	CDU	−0.104	−0.35	−0.70	0.537	0.750
	Grüne	**−0.250**	**−3.66**	**−7.33**	**0.005**	0.125
	SPD	−0.146	−1.16	−2.32	0.103	0.125
	Linke	**−0.313**	**−2.98**	**−5.97**	**0.009**	0.125
Open-Mindedness	**AfD**	**0.771**	**1.61**	**3.23**	**0.048**	0.125
	CDU	**0.646**	**2.06**	**4.11**	**0.026**	0.125
	Grüne	**0.646**	**1.72**	**3.44**	**0.041**	0.125
	SPD	**0.834**	**2.36**	**4.71**	**0.018**	0.125
	Linke	**0.771**	**1.93**	**3.87**	**0.031**	0.125